

Monday, 8 June 2026.

Your daily radio show prep — three top news stories, forward-looking showbiz, sport that matters this week, talkback prompts, and day notes for today and tomorrow. Built fresh every weekday, ready by 3pm for tomorrow's show.

00 — WEATHER

Tomorrow's forecast

LONDON

Rain

17° 13°

BIRMINGHAM

Rain

16° 12°

MANCHESTER

Light rain

16° 11°

GLASGOW

Light rain

15° 10°

01 — NEWS

Today's top stories

1

MI5 warns Chinese spies using job websites to target government staff.

Undercover agents are posing as fake job recruiters to try and identify useful targets, MI5 warns.

UK · NEWS

2

Royal Mail delivers new parent magazine to father 19 years late.

Paul Edwards, 52, was left baffled after the magazine finally arrived almost two decades late.

UK · NEWS

3

Senior member of Kinahan crime group sentenced to 24 years in prison.

Sean McGovern will serve two sentences of directing the activities of a criminal organisation.

UK · NEWS

02 – SHOWBIZ

What's coming up

1

How a virtual space battle lost gamers £400,000.

One of the most violent chapters in EVE Online history wiped out an empire that had taken years to build.

SHOWBIZ · UK

2

Primavera fans react after headline acts Doja Cat and Massive Attack cancelled over weather.

Fans have expressed their confusion that no back-up plan was put in place at the festival in Barcelona.

SHOWBIZ · UK

3

'Traitor' - Elmo in hot water with New Yorkers over Knicks NBA finals.

The Sesame Street character, whose fictional home is in New York, was called a traitor after not fully backing the city's basketball team.

SHOWBIZ · UK

On the schedule

- 1 'A World Cup for them not us': Fans' anger at US travel bans and visa restrictions.**
Fans across the world say US travel bans and visa regulations make them feel excluded from the World Cup.
SPORT · UK
- 2 Bellingham has fight to start for England - Tuchel.**
Jude Bellingham has a fight on his hands to feature in England's starting line-up at the World Cup, says manager Thomas Tuchel.
SPORT · UK
- 3 Eriksen 'in good spirits' after collapse.**
Christian Eriksen is "in good spirits" following his collapse against Ukraine and is expected to be discharged from hospital soon, says Denmark's national team doctor Morten Boesen.
SPORT · UK
- 4 Mourinho set for Real after Perez re-elected.**
Jose Mourinho is set to confirmed as Real Madrid's new head coach after Florentino Perez was re-elected as the club's president until 2030.
SPORT · UK

Quick hits

- 1 The average Brit checks their phone 159 times a day — but says it 'doesn't feel like that much'.**
Researchers using passive monitoring apps say we badly underestimate our own usage. Most people guess between 30 and 70 times.
- 2 62% of us have lied about reading a book to look smart in front of someone we fancy.**
Most-faked titles: 1984, Pride and Prejudice and (awkwardly) the Bible. One in five admit to faking a whole dinner-party conversation about a novel they'd only seen the cover of.
- 3 Cycling to the shops is up, with more people using bikes for short local trips rather than big rides.**
Councils credit better cycle lanes. The number one cargo carried? A surprisingly heavy single bag for life.
- 4 Britons are keeping their phones for longer than ever before upgrading.**
The average handset is now held onto for several years. The main reason cited isn't loyalty — it's the dread of moving everything across.
- 5 The humble flask is having a comeback, with sales up sharply as people try to cut café spending.**
Retailers say the big winner is the 'keeps drinks hot for 12 hours' bottle — though most of us still drink it within the first one.
- 6 'Quiet' holidays are the new luxury, with travellers seeking places with nothing much to do.**
Tour operators report rising demand for remote cottages and slow trains. The number one requested feature: a reliable kettle and a view.
- 7 More households are growing herbs on the windowsill to cut grocery bills.**
Basil and mint are the favourites. Survival rates, gardeners admit, are 'mixed' — the basil rarely makes it past a fortnight.

05 – TALKBACK

For the phone lines

OUR SURVEY SAID

Q 82% of us secretly enjoy doing THIS, even though we'd never admit it. What?

ANSWER: WATCHING NEIGHBOURS THROUGH THE CURTAINS.

Q When asked what they'd grab in a house fire after their pets and family, 40% said THIS. What?

ANSWER: THE PHONE CHARGER.

TALK TOPIC

- **A survey says most of us have given a nickname to a stranger we see regularly.**
Who's the person on your route you've secretly named — and what did you call them?

- **Apparently the average person changes their mind about their favourite biscuit three times in a lifetime.**
What's your current number one — and what's it knocked off the top spot?

TRUE STORY OR JACKANORY – LISTENERS GUESS

FACT **Food.** Honey is one of the only foods that effectively never spoils. Sealed pots found in ancient tombs have reportedly still been edible thousands of years later.

FICTION **Made up, but believable.** A chippy in Lancashire now offers a 'loyalty' batter — regulars get their initials piped onto the fish in a special edible sauce.

06 – LOTTERY

Jackpots ahead

NEXT EUROMILLIONS JACKPOT

£2 million

Next Tuesday or Friday · estimated

NEXT NATIONAL LOTTERY JACKPOT

£2 million

Next Wednesday or Saturday · estimated

07 – FACTS OF THE DAY

Did you know?

- Cows have best friends and get stressed when separated from them.
- The word 'OK' began as a misspelling joke in a Boston newspaper in 1839 ('oll korrekt').
- Sloths can hold their breath longer than dolphins — up to 40 minutes underwater.
- If you could fold a piece of paper 42 times, it would reach the moon.
- Bees can recognise human faces.
- Saturn would float in water — if you could find a bathtub big enough.
- There's a species of jellyfish that is technically immortal — *Turritopsis dohrnii*.
- Antarctica is the only continent without reptiles or snakes.

On this day

Day 159 of the year, 206 days left in 2026. Today Christian feast day: Chlodulf of Metz; Christian feast day: Jacques Berthieu, S.J.; Christian feast day: Jadwiga (Hedwig) of Poland; Christian feast day: Mariam Thresia Chiramel. Star sign Gemini, birthstone Pearl.

TODAY'S BIRTHDAYS

- 1940 — Nancy Sinatra, American singer and actress
- 1977 — Kanye West, American rapper, producer, director, and fashion designer
- 1943 — Colin Baker, English actor
- 1942 — Doug Mountjoy, Welsh snooker player (died 2021)
- 1966 — Julianna Margulies, American actress
- 1951 — Tony Rice, American bluegrass musician (died 2020)
- 1981 — Sara Watkins, American fiddle, ukulele, and guitar player
- 1970 — Kelli Williams, American actress and director

THE DAY TODAY

- 2007 — Space Shuttle Atlantis is launched on STS-117 carrying two truss segments and solar arrays to the International Space Station.
- 1968 — James Earl Ray, the man who assassinated Martin Luther King Jr. is arrested at London Heathrow Airport.
- 1995 — Downed U.S. Air Force pilot Captain Scott O'Grady is rescued by U.S. Marines in Bosnia.

TODAY IN MUSIC

- 1953 — An F5 tornado hits Beecher, Michigan, United States, killing 116, injuring 844, and destroying 340 homes.
- 1972 — Vietnam War: Nine-year-old Phan Thị Kim Phúc is burned by napalm, an event captured in a photograph moments later while the young girl is seen running naked down a road, in what would become an iconic, Pulitzer Prize-winning photo.

TODAY IN HISTORY

- 1982 — Bluff Cove Air Attacks during the Falklands War: Fifty-six British servicemen are killed by an Argentine air attack on two landing ships, RFA Sir Galahad and RFA Sir Tristram.

- 1961 — Marriage of Prince Edward, Duke of Kent to Katharine Worsley at York Minster.
- 1995 — Downed U.S. Air Force pilot Captain Scott O'Grady is rescued by U.S. Marines in Bosnia.

A peek at tomorrow

Day 160 of the year, 205 days left in 2026. Today Anniversary of the Accession of King Abdullah II (Jordan); Autonomy Day (Åland); Christian feast day: Aidan of Lindisfarne (Evangelical Lutheran Church in America); Christian feast day: Blessed Anna Maria Taigi. Star sign Gemini, birthstone Pearl.

TOMORROW'S BIRTHDAYS

- 1912 — Ingolf Dahl, German-American pianist, composer, and conductor (died 1970)
- 1954 — Pete Byrne, English singer-songwriter
- 1926 — Calvin "Fuzz" Jones, American singer and bass player (died 2010)
- 1915 — Les Paul, American guitarist and songwriter (died 2009)
- 1961 — Aaron Sorkin, American screenwriter, producer, and playwright
- 1977 — Usman Afzaal, Pakistani-English cricketer
- 1953 — Ken Navarro, Italian-American guitarist and composer
- 1988 — Mae Whitman, American actress

THE DAY TOMORROW

- 1928 — Charles Kingsford Smith completes the first trans-Pacific flight in a Fokker Trimotor monoplane, the Southern Cross.
- 1965 — Vietnam War: The Viet Cong commences combat with the Army of the Republic of Vietnam in the Battle of Đồng Xoài, one of the largest battles in the war.
- 2008 — Two bombs explode at a train station near Algiers, Algeria, killing at least 13 people.

TOMORROW IN MUSIC

- 1965 — Vietnam War: The Viet Cong commences combat with the Army of the Republic of Vietnam in the Battle of Đồng Xoài, one of the largest battles in the war.
- 1954 — Joseph N. Welch, special counsel for the United States Army, lashes out at Senator Joseph McCarthy during the Army-McCarthy hearings, giving McCarthy the famous rebuke, "You've done enough. Have you no sense of decency, sir, at long last? Have you left no sense of decency?"

Coming to cinemas

JUNE 2026	
FRI 12	Scary Movie 6; new Spielberg film (+ IMAX)
FRI 19	Pixar's Toy Story 5
FRI 26	Supergirl: Woman of Tomorrow (+ IMAX); A Private Life

JULY 2026	
WED 1	Minions & Monsters
FRI 3	Shiver; Young Washington
FRI 10	Moana (live action); Evil Dead Burn
FRI 17	Christopher Nolan's The Odyssey (+ IMAX); Cut Off
FRI 24	Heads of State; Untitled DCU
FRI 31	Spider-Man: Brand New Day

AUGUST 2026	
FRI 7	Once Upon a Time in a Cinema
FRI 14	Flowervale Street; PAW Patrol 3: The Dino Movie
FRI 21	Mutiny; The Bride!
FRI 28	Crime 101; Outcome

SEPTEMBER 2026 • PREVIEW	
FRI 4	Conjuring: Last Rites
FRI 11	Resident Evil reboot
FRI 18	The Black Phone 2
FRI 25	Tron: Ares (+ IMAX)

OCTOBER 2026 • PREVIEW	
FRI 16	Untitled Christopher McQuarrie thriller
FRI 23	Frankenstein (del Toro)

On the sporting calendar

JUNE 2026		JULY 2026	
11 JUN – 19 JUL	FIFA World Cup (USA / Canada / Mexico)	4–26 JUL	Tour de France (Cycling)
11–14 JUN	World Cup of Darts	SUN 5	British Grand Prix, Silverstone
12 JUN – 5 JUL	ICC Women's T20 World Cup (England & Wales)	16–19 JUL	The Open Championship (Golf)
18–21 JUN	U.S. Open (Golf)	18–26 JUL	World Matchplay Darts, Blackpool
29 JUN – 12 JUL	Wimbledon	23 JUL – 2 AUG	Commonwealth Games, Glasgow
		AUGUST 2026	
		W/C 10	Hundred & T20 Blast climax (Cricket)
		SAT 15	Premier League season begins (2026/27)
		22–23	Belgian Grand Prix (F1)